

5.2 Where Does It Come From?

While search is nothing new to the Windows world, what separates the Vista offering from the one of old is that this is, technically speaking, “search-as-you-type,” or a live search feature. You do not have to complete your query and press [Enter] to trigger the actual search (which might take a few minutes in older versions of Windows). Search starts on your data as soon as you start entering your query. So how is this done?

What Vista does is, it creates an index on all your content. An index file is essentially Vista drilling through your content and filing the various bits and bytes that define your content into multiple files. Thus Vista already knows which file contains what and where it is located—this is why the results are displayed instantaneously; Vista is essentially just filtering out all the data you do not need, based on your query.



Vista's indexing options



Indexed locations

Note, however, that Vista does not index everything by default. It focuses the indexing on specific locations such as your personal